

The Tantra Called the Glorious Great Vajrabhairava

Śrī Vajra Mahābhairava Nāma Tantra · Toh 468 · Derge Kangyur

དཔལ་རྫོང་འཛིན་སྐྱོང་བྱེད་ཆུང་པའི་རྒྱ་ཅས་བ་བྱ།

Toh 468 in the Kangyur is the tantra known in Sanskrit as the Śrī Vajra Mahābhairava Nāma Tantra and in Tibetan as Dpal Rdo rje 'jigs byed chen po'i rgyud, rendered into English as the Tantra Called the Glorious Great Vajrabhairava. It belongs to the class of Anuttarayoga tantras and centers on Vajrabhairava, a wrathful deity described as the King of Wrath who inspires terror in all the gods, presenting instructions for his ritual accomplishment. The text sets out the practical context for this practice, specifying a range of suitable locations — from charnel grounds and river banks to crossroads and mountain peaks — in which the mantra practitioner should work toward the fulfillment of various purposes. As a tantra devoted to one of the most important wrathful meditational deities of the Vajrayana tradition, it holds a significant place among the tantric scriptures preserved in the Kangyur.

Revised by Vajraghosa.

In the Sanskrit language: Śrī Vajra Mahābhairava Nāma Tantra. In the Tibetan language: The Tantra Called the Glorious Great Vajrabhairava.

Homage to the Glorious Great Vajrabhairava, King of Wrath.

Then the accomplishment of Vajrabhairava is here explained completely and correctly. It is supremely fierce toward all the gods and causes them great terror.

For this practice, first the mantra practitioner should reside in whatever pleasing place suits them, and there accomplish all purposes. The places mentioned for this are: a charnel ground, the bank of a river, an isolated tree, a crossroads with a single marker, a four-way crossroads, a mountain peak, an empty house, the dwelling of the Mamos, a god's temple, a battlefield, a city, a forest, or a village — in any such location the mantra practitioner should take up residence.

A yogin who has received the empowerment of the Glorious Great Vajrabhairava should accomplish through this rite the following: subjugation, hooking, killing, driving away, separating, paralysis, the sword rite, eye

medicine, the underground rite, pills, transmutation into gold, essence extraction, wealth, elementals, the walking dead, flesh-eaters, yakṣas, female yakṣas, nāgas, and so forth.

As for the rite itself, the mantra practitioner first smears the body with the great ashes of burnt corpses. At midnight, naked with disheveled hair, using the yoga of the noble buffalo-faced one, one draws the maṇḍala in a charnel ground or similar place.

Square in form, with four gates,
adorned with four archways,
bells, silk streamers, and the like,
entirely spread with garlands of flowers.
In all the corners and in the spaces
along the gateway thresholds,
ornamented with vajras and jewels,
and likewise with half-moon forms.

In the center, one draws the wheel — a circular grid of nine cells. One gate is to be left open, while all the remaining sides are to be completely closed off.

In the center one draws a human corpse: the head toward the east, the hands toward the south, the intestines toward the west, the feet toward the north. In the southeast corner, a skull. In the southwest, a skull-grove. In the northwest, a cloth from the charnel ground. In the northeast, a man impaled upon a bright stake.

These are the five mudrās of the charnel-ground seal placed in the center of the wheel.

Then the outer mudrās of the wheel: on the eastern panel, one draws a curved blade, a single-pointed lance, a pestle, a flaying knife, a single-pointed vajra, an iron hook, and the like. On the southern panel, one draws an axe, an arrow, a khaṭvāṅga, a staff, a wheel, a vajra-noose, and the like. On the western panel, one draws a vajra, a small hammer, a tent, a bow, a bell, a wind-banner, and the like. On the northern panel, one draws a threatening finger gesture, a three-pronged peg, elephant hide, a vajra-hammer, a spear, a fire-hearth, and the like. On all four gates and corners, one draws great walking corpses.

If one desires the supreme spiritual attainment, one offers great butter-lamps. As flesh offerings one presents: human flesh, donkey, she-mule, dog, fox, buffalo, elephant, ox, yak, sheep, deer, pig, and the like. Furthermore, one

offers the flesh of: vulture, owl, crow, hawk, otter, black turtle, laughing thrush, peacock, domestic fowl, monkey, great evil-omened creatures, and the like.

With utterly concentrated meditative equipoise, one performs the rites of eating, feast offering, fire offering, and tormā offering. On all the corners of the maṇḍala, one sprinkles blood repeatedly. Remaining in the yoga of the union with the buffalo face of the Glorious Vajrabhairava, one offers all the divine food substances.

Then the mantra practitioner performs the preliminary conduct.

One anoints the body with Vairocana while alone, or together with a harmonious companion with whom one is at peace. Stripping naked, one loosens the hair. At midnight, one sounds a bell, uttering "ha ha," and settles into meditative equipoise. One who desires the accomplishments (siddhi) should enter into the maṇḍala of the Great Glorious Vajrabhairava.

One offers drink such as exquisitely fragrant beer, and the various flavors of food. Then, from outside, one visualizes the accomplishments and what is not accomplishment, and above that one contemplates the Great Glorious Vajrabhairava with the buffalo face.

Remaining in front of him in the right-contracted posture, with one-pointed mind and with pride, one recites the ten-syllable mantra in very even, settled meditative equipoise.

If a great terror then arises, the mantra practitioner must not be afraid. If one becomes afraid, that constitutes the obstacle of a great obstructor. If an obstacle arises, the accomplishment will not be achieved. Therefore the mantra practitioner must not be afraid. In that very fearlessness, the Great Glorious Vajrabhairava is pleased. Having been pleased, he declares, "What do you desire?" At that point the knowledge-holder should speak, saying: "A sword, subterranean treasure, eye medicine, the transmutation of gold, essence extraction, or whatever other accomplishment I desire in my mind — grant these to me without fail." Even if the mantra practitioner does not achieve all of those in a hundred attempts, all the subtle activities of that practice will certainly be accomplished.

This is the first chapter, showing the maṇḍala, from the Tantra of the Yoga Wheel of the Great Glorious Vajrabhairava, known by the name Mañjuśrī.

Then the rites of the assemblage of activities are fully explained. Accordingly, in due order, activities such as slaying and expelling are to be performed by the wrathful mantra practitioner while abiding in the practice of the Great Glorious Vajrabhairava. First, for a time, the mantra practitioner performs slaying. Why? Because yoga is the principal. In the tantra of yoga, one who possesses the divine practice first performs that, for it is the principal of all practice.

The activity here is as follows. The mantra practitioner who desires to slay draws the wheel of the Great Glorious Vajrabhairava in sixteen spokes on charnel-ground cloth, using a quill pen made from the root feathers of a great crow, or a pen made from human bone, naked, with disheveled hair, facing south — writing it in the practice of the buffalo face — using poison, blood, salt, emblic myrobalan, neem, and the juice of datura.

One places it in the center of two fires, together with the name of the one to be accomplished against, and surrounds it with the ten-syllable mantra, writing eight HŪṂ syllables. On the corners one writes PHAṬ syllables. One anoints one's own body with hot butter. One inserts the yantra between two skulls, places it on top of a tripod, lights the charnel-ground fire blazingly, presses down with the left foot, and recites the ten-syllable mantra. Through this, the target will die without doubt in an instant.

Furthermore, if one desires to strike with epidemic disease, one places that same wheel neatly between two fish skins of a human, digs down half a cubit beneath a fireplace, inserts it, and lights the fire — then the person will be seized by epidemic illness.

Here is taught the practice of the sixteen-spoked wheel. However, the particular feature of this version is that the thirty-two-syllable mantra is combined with the ten-syllable mantra together with the name of the one to be accomplished against, merging the syllables and mantras.

Together with the substances mentioned previously, and with the remnants left by crows — impure leavings — one smears these together with Vairocana on charnel-ground cloth. One then draws the wheel according to the rite described previously. If it is hidden in a charnel ground, the person will die. If it is hidden at the base of a single tree, the person will be expelled.

If it is hidden at the base of a single tree, the person will be separated. If it is hidden in water, the person will become mad. If it is placed in a house, the person will be pacified. If it is retrieved and thoroughly washed, the person will

be freed.

There is also another rite that is taught: the Wheel of Yama is drawn on charnel-ground cloth according to the previously described rite, and then one makes an effigy of the one to be accomplished against, eight finger-breadths in measure, using charnel-ground charcoal. The mantra of the wheel is inserted into the chest of this effigy, and it is pierced at the five vital points with a stake made of human bone. All the joints are filled with sharp thorns. This is then placed between two skulls.

Then, in a pit or at seven locations, one buries earth shaped as a figure of Yama about a cubit in size — with a gnashing face, a great belly, a single face, two arms, holding in his hands a sword and a lasso, naked, and with disheveled hair. The two skulls are placed at the chest of this figure. At midday or midnight, one hides it in a charnel ground or a cremation site, orienting the head facing south, and buries it face down. When one returns home, entering into meditative equipoise and applying the sādhana of the mahā face together with the name of the one to be accomplished against, one recites the ten-syllable mantra. If this is done, within three days the person will die. If the image is retrieved and washed, the person will be freed.

Next, a rite for causing madness is taught. One writes the ten-syllable mantra on the skin of a chameleon using poison and other such substances. That skin is then filled with dust from the footprint of the one to be accomplished against and soil from the trail of their urine, and bound with that person's hair. Then, from outside, one sprinkles it together with Vairocana and donkey urine, filling a clay bowl. The wheel is placed inside this, set upon a cremation fire, pressed down with the left foot, and while applying the sādhana of Yama one recites the ten-syllable mantra. If this is done, within one day the person is driven mad. This is the rite for those who cannot be subdued by subsequent measures. The mantra practitioner performs this rite in a state of extreme wrath.

There is also a rite for separation. One draws the Wheel of Yama according to the previously described rite, and using earth from seven locations one fashions a buffalo and a horse. One places these two one upon the other, inserts the wheel into the chest of each of the two, and sets them at the base of a neem tree. The wheel too is written with the blood of a buffalo and a horse. This is a special application of the mantra: if performed in very deep meditative equipoise, within three days it causes separation.

If the mantra practitioner then wishes to drive someone away, one fashions a vixen from earth of seven locations. On its back one visualizes the syllable YAM fully transforming into a wind maṇḍala in the shape of a half-moon, and above that one visualizes the one to be accomplished against. Behind that person one visualizes the form of Yama holding a club in his hand, striking the person with that club and, with face looking southward, dragging them away. If the wheel, along with the name of the one to be accomplished against written out in full according to the rite described above, is inserted into the chest of this figure, within seven days the person will without doubt be driven away.

There is yet another rite that is taught. On the day of the sun, one smears an acacia tree with piping-hot butter and climbs it, setting a butter lamp there. The butter of the body is scraped off with a fish-scale and retained in that location. That butter is then taken and the banner cloth of the Great God (Śiva) is taken and burned; the soot from the smoke produced during its burning and that butter are combined together, and this mixture is smeared on the sandal of the one one wishes to drive away. If it is also smeared on both hands and feet of that person, they are driven away in an instant.

There is yet another rite that is taught: on charnel-ground cloth or on birch leaves, one draws the wind maṇḍala using a quill pen with crow's blood and crow's feathers as the ink.

In the center of the wind maṇḍala, one writes the name of the person to be acted upon, binds it at the throat of one who eats the torma offering, then seizes a crow and, holding it in the conjunction of the skull, faces south and hurls it. In that very instant, like the crow, the target is sent spinning across the earth in all directions.

There is yet another rite of driving away: one smears hot butter on a nest taken from a neem tree in which one who eats the torma offering has dwelt. One then takes the ash from burning that nest with wood from the father tree of the neem, and pours it over the head of the person to be driven away. That person will be expelled.

There is yet another supreme rite of separation: feathers of a crow and an owl, and a single hair each from a brahmin and a fierce man, are combined together. One kindles a fire in datura wood and burns them in a smokeless flame. Taking that ash and reciting the ten-syllable mantra, if one places the ash between a woman and a man, they are separated in that very instant.

Next, one takes charnel-ground cloth and, having sprinkled it with poison and other such substances, writes the name of the person to be acted upon. One takes thorns, serpent hair, and serpent skin, inserts them into it, and fashions it into a bundle. If this is burned in the house of any person, those within will fight one another.

Now, for one who wishes to kill: one fashions an effigy from urine and feces, thoroughly smears it with powdered bone, combs it with the hair from a charnel-ground fire, faces south, and with the conjunction of the skull, at midnight stabs and burns it. If this is done together with the name of a given person, that person dies in that very instant. This rite was taught by Vajrabhairava the Great himself.

Now, for one who wishes to drive away: on banner cloth, one draws, using a sixteen-petal wheel, the ten-syllable mantra together with the substances and charnel-ground charcoal previously mentioned, writing the name of the person in question. If this banner is planted on a neem tree, that person will be expelled.

For one who wishes to paralyze: if one writes the name of the person clearly on the wheel of Yamārāja, either inscribed on copper or on cloth, using lac and turmeric, and leaves it in place, that person will become paralyzed.

If the mantrin wishes to bring someone under his power: soil from an anthill, saffron, musk, lac, and turmeric are combined together. If one makes a sixteen-finger effigy of the person to be subjugated, whether male or female, and draws the wheel of Yamārāja on barley husks using musk and blood from the ring finger, places it in the heart of the effigy, keeps it in one's own home, offers red flowers at the three times of day, faces west, and recites the ten-syllable mantra, then within seven days even Śakra himself would come under one's power — to say nothing of an ordinary person. If one further wishes to summon that person, one draws a wheel on a skull using musk and blood from the ring finger, heats it over an acacia fire, and recites together with the name of the one to be called. In that very instant, like the force of the wind, that person will be summoned.

If the mantrin wishes to drive someone mad: one takes datura fruit and mixes it with the powder of wood eaten by wood-worms, combined with raw flesh, and gives it to the target as food and drink, while also reciting the mantra. In that very instant the person goes mad, and within seven days dies.

Then yet another rite is taught: the mantra of Yamārāja is written on charnel-ground cloth using poison and other such substances. One makes an effigy using large butter lamps and Vairocana, places a wheel in its heart, goes to the father's dwelling place, and, with a sharp weapon, stabs it in the fire used for cremating corpses. The yogin then remains in the conjunction of the stacked-elements practice, anoints the body with Vairocana, faces south, and burns it. The target will die swiftly.

Now there follows a rite involving the forehead, beginning with the crow and —

One takes the bones of an owl, and upon these two, using iron thorns, one writes the ten-syllable mantra together with the name of the target. Remaining alone in a place, one recites it together with that person's name, and when one drags them one against the other, a separation will occur.

Then, upon the petals of the Yamārāja wheel, one writes the names of the woman and the man, inserts them into the belly of a frog, and hides them beneath a threshold inscribed with the name of the target. That person's limbs will be pierced as if by weapons.

Then follows this rite for inflaming a girl with desire. One writes the mantra of Yamārāja on charnel-ground cloth using poison and other such substances, builds an effigy about a cubit tall from the ashes used to cremate corpses, places a wheel in its heart, presses it down with the left foot, and recites the ten-syllable mantra, saying: "By the conjunction of Mahī, may the daughter of such-and-such a great one swiftly be inflamed with desire." She will indeed be inflamed.

These rites must not be disclosed to anyone else. If a mantrin of deluded character performs them, he will certainly fall into hell.

In order to benefit those who harm the Three Jewels, who show contempt for the guru, who have broken their samaya vows, who slander the mantras and tantras, and who harm sentient beings, the mantrin should apply injury with a mind moved by compassion. If done for other purposes, the samaya is broken and one falls into great calamity.

I have explained this also in other tantras. It is declared in verse:

Those persons who revile the ācārya,
who denigrate the Great Vehicle,
who slander the tantras' yoga and primordial wisdom —
they should be forcefully slain,

or at the very least driven from their dwelling.
A yogin who, lacking compassion,
applies such acts indiscriminately toward others —
upon that one, precisely the same act
will come back in return.
Why does the yogin undertake this?
Solely so that sentient beings may attain.

This is the second chapter — the chapter on the accomplishment of all rites —
from the tantra of the yoga of the glorious great Vajrabhairava, known as
Mañjuśrī.

Then is thoroughly proclaimed the collection of attachment-mantras in their
proper order. The mantrin should dwell in a very pure region and there collect
the mantras. As follows:

In the sixth, the first; in the fifth, the fifth; in the sixth, the second, furnished
with the second vowel-letter; in the second, the third, again furnished with the
second vowel-letter; in the seventh, the third as well; in the fourth, the third,
furnished with the thirteenth vowel-letter; in the fifth, the fifth, furnished with
the eleventh vowel-letter; in the sixth, the first; the first of the sixth becomes
doubled; then add the wind-seed; in the fifth, the fifth, pressed together with
eleven; in the fourth, the third, pressed equally with the thirteenth; in the
sixth, the second, furnished with the fifth vowel-letter; in the third, the fifth,
then add the wind-seed, furnished with the full thirteenth vowel-letter; in the
fourth, the third, then add the wind-seed; in the sixth, the first; in the fourth,
the third, and to that the wind-seed furnished with the thirteenth vowel-letter;
in the fourth, the fifth, furnished with the third vowel-letter, then add the
fire-seed, and likewise the wind-seed, then add the final letter furnished with
the eleventh vowel-letter, and likewise the excellent wind-seed; in the sixth,
the first, then add the final letter furnished with the eleventh vowel-letter; then
again the wind-seed; in the second, the first — make that doubled; in the
fourth, the fifth, furnished with the third vowel-letter, then the fire-seed; in the
fifth, the fifth, then add the wind-seed.

In the first, give Vairocana; joined with the lord of the supreme; in the fifth, the
second; and in the third, the first — the learned one should recite these twice.
This is the root mantra of the great wrathful one of what is called the Mañjuśrī
Mahābhairava Tantra Wheel, the buffalo-faced one. By reciting it one hundred

thousand times, one accomplishes all activities. This is the king of mantras; what has not arisen will not come to arise.

In the fourth syllable of the fourth, furnished with the fourth vowel-letter, give the fire-seed below; then the lord of the realm at the sixteenth end. In the second of the seventh, furnished with the fourth vowel-letter, and in the first of the third, affix the fire-seed below — the lord of the realm at the sixteenth end. In the fourth of the sixth, furnished with the third vowel-letter; also the first of the first, furnished with the seventh vowel-letter; give the fire-seed below. In the first of the fourth, furnished with the second vowel-letter; the fifth of the fourth — the learned one recites twice. In the first, give Vairocana; to the seed of the eighth semivowel, furnished with the sixth vowel-letter, adorned at the crown with a bindu; in the fifth, the second; and in the third, the first. This is the king of mantras; it is the application of the buffalo-faced one, and it accomplishes all activities. It is renowned as the mantra of activity. If one recites it three hundred thousand times, one accomplishes all activities.

In the first of the sixth, and also in the fifth of the fifth, furnished with the second vowel-letter; the first of the fourth — place its fifth on top; the first of the first; in the first, give Vairocana; to the seed of the eighth semivowel, furnished with the sixth vowel-letter, adorned at the crown with a bindu; in the fifth, the second; and in the third, the first. This is renowned as the heart mantra of the buffalo-faced one. If one recites each syllable one hundred thousand times, one accomplishes whatever activities there may be in the three worlds, all of them without exception. At the time of this ritual of gathering the mantras, one should make offerings. This is the third chapter, teaching the gathering of mantras, from the Tantra of the Yoga of Glorious Great Vajra-Bhairava, called Mañjuśrī.

Thereupon the accomplishment of Vajra-Bhairava is fully explained. Preceded by the selflessness of all phenomena, one is to visualize the deity. First of all, by reciting the mantra of natural purity, having rendered all phenomena into the mode of selflessness, one visualizes in the middle of space the wind maṇḍala — dark blue in appearance, arisen from the form of the syllable YAM. Above that, one visualizes the moon maṇḍala arising from the first vowel-letter. Above that, one visualizes arising from the form of the syllable DHĪḤ the form of Mañjuśrī as a youth. There, one visualizes the sun maṇḍala arisen from the form of the syllable A. From that sun maṇḍala, rays of light stream forth, intensely summoning the Tathāgatas dwelling in the ten directions, the bodhisattvas, the goddesses of knowledge (vidyā-devatās), the

wrathful ones, and so forth; they come and are visualized as seated upon the sun maṇḍala. Then Mañjuśrī and those Tathāgatas and the rest become unified and are visualized in the sun maṇḍala. In the aspect of blazing rays of light, one visualizes them as radiantly pervading a hundred thousand leagues in every direction. Above that, one visualizes the syllable HŪṂ, dark blue in color, perfectly endowed with the five rays of light. From that HŪṂ, light streams forth in the form of rays, re-enters as previously described, and from that syllable one is to visualize the great vajra standing upright, black in color and endowed with the five rays of light.

From that vajra, one visualizes filling the sun as sesame seeds fill a sesame pod — an immeasurable multitude of subtle forms of buddhas, bodhisattvas, wrathful ones, and vidyā goddesses (Skt. vidyādevī), all dwelling upon the sun. Those buddhas and the rest then thoroughly tame sentient beings, bringing them to full ripening, and establish them in awakening. Thereupon one visualizes all of them gathered together once more and fully entered into the form of the vajra.

That very form of the vajra has nine faces. It is the great terrifying vajra with the face of a buffalo (Skt. mahiṣa), blazing like the fire at the end of an age, capable of consuming the three realms. The mouths are gnashing. The tongue coils as it utters "Hā Hā." The furrowed brow of the glaring, wrathful gaze is terrifying. From alongside those wrathful brows, the eyebrows and eyes are wrathful, roaring like the time of a great and terrible eon. It devours human blood, fat, marrow, and flesh. It points the threatening finger at gods and the rest, both worldly and supramundane. It devours Śakra (Indra), Brahmā, the Great Lord (Śiva), Viṣṇu, yakṣas, and the like. The crown is adorned with a skull — terrible, with a crest of gnashing skulls — making it a crown of skulls, utterly fearsome. Crying out "PHAṬ!" and adorned with the ornament of a garland of hanging skulls, it has sixteen feet. Naked in form, the male organ is upright. The left leg is extended. The belly is vast. The hair is wild, standing upright. It instills great terror, crying out "PHEṂ!" It is possessed of thirty-four arms.

It holds a fresh elephant hide. This is the glorious great terrifying vajra with the buffalo face, to be thoroughly visualized. Having thus stabilized the visualization extremely well, the mantrin should always meditate in deep equipoise through the practice of suchness.

The first right hand holds a curved knife, the second holds a single-pointed weapon, the third holds a pestle, the fourth holds a flaying knife, the fifth holds a single-pointed vajra, the sixth holds an axe, the seventh holds a short spear, the eighth holds an arrow, the ninth holds an iron hook, the tenth holds a club, the eleventh holds a khaṭvāṅga staff, the twelfth holds a wheel, the thirteenth holds a vajra, the fourteenth holds a vajra hammer, the fifteenth holds a sword, the sixteenth holds a bell.

The first left hand holds a skull cup, the second holds a severed head, the third holds a shield, the fourth holds a leg, the fifth holds a lasso, the sixth holds a bow, the seventh holds entrails, the eighth holds a hand bell, the ninth holds a hand, the tenth holds a charnel-ground shroud, the eleventh holds a man impaled upon a sharpened stake, the twelfth holds a fire pit, the thirteenth holds a skull bowl, the fourteenth points the threatening finger, the fifteenth holds a three-pronged trident, the sixteenth holds a charnel-ground cloth blown by the wind. The two principal hands hold the fresh elephant hide.

Among the right feet: the first treads upon a human, the second upon a buffalo, the third upon an ox, the fourth upon a donkey, the fifth upon a camel, the sixth upon a dog, the seventh upon a sheep, the eighth upon a fox. The right feet ride upon these.

Among the left feet: the first treads upon a vulture, the second upon an owl, the third upon a crow, the fourth upon a parrot, the fifth upon a hawk, the sixth upon a great garuḍa, the seventh upon a lizard, the eighth upon a laughing one. The left feet press down upon these.

The first and principal face of the glorious great terrifying one is very dark, in the form of a buffalo, of intensely wrathful aspect. On the three faces of the right horn: the first is blue, the second is red, the third is yellow — these three faces of the lord are intensely wrathful. On the three faces of the left horn: the first is white, the second is smoky, the third is black, intensely wrathful. These gnashing faces are to be thoroughly visualized.

Between the two horns, the central face is red and utterly terrifying, and one visualizes blood dripping from the mouth. Above, the face of Mañjuśrī — slightly yellowish, momentarily wrathful, adorned with the ornaments of a youth, with the five braided locks at the crown — is to be thoroughly visualized.

All the faces are to be visualized as having three eyes. Thus one always fixes one's attention single-pointedly in this way. Having meditated that this very

one — the glorious great Vajrabhairava (Skt. Vajrabhairava), he who bears the face of the buffalo — is oneself, the yogin who abides in the state of the hero then recites the mantra aloud. At the time of recitation, one visualizes a solar disc at one's own heart center, and upon it one places the syllables of one's own mantra. Blazing, with a mind outwardly undistracted, one performs the recitation.

The mantra practitioner who abides in this practice
should always perform every act as Bhairava.

Meditate while dwelling in a charnel ground,
and always consume the five nectars.

By this there is no other means of accomplishment than accomplishment
itself.

Moreover, consuming large amounts of oil lamps,
the yogin who wanders at night
should recite the root mantra three hundred thousand times.

The mantra practitioner who recites this
will come to perform every act.

This is the fourth section on visualization, taken from the tantra called the
Mañjuśrī — that is, the glorious great Vajrabhairava.

Then the glorious great Bhairava teaches and fully expounds the ritual of the
painted icon. One uses a hero's cloth, or cloth that has covered a corpse, or
cloth bearing flowers, or cloth on which a male child has been born. If none of
these are to be found, any cloth will do. The painter should be excellent, free
of conceptual agitation, not prone to anger, pure, skilled, of a composed mind,
endowed with faith, compassionate, free from craving, and thus endowed with
such qualities. With the hands of such a painter, one draws the image on the
hero's cloth. If one desires accomplishment, one makes offerings to the hero.
The ritual procedure is as follows: dwelling in a secret place, one draws with
deep meditative equipoise. The painter and the practitioner may see the
image, but it must be drawn so that other worldly people cannot see it. It
should depict sixteen feet, thirty-four hands, nine faces, naked, of a black
color, with the left leg extended, bearing a form that terrorizes even the
greatly terrifying.

Draw the thangka with the emblem erect upward. The first face is the buffalo.
On the right side of the horns there are three faces: draw them blue, red, and
yellow, intensely wrathful. On the left: white, smoky, and black. In the center

between the two horns, draw a deeply red face. Above that, draw the face of Mañjuśrī, slightly yellow and mildly wrathful.

In the right hands: a curved knife, a single-pointed blade, a pestle, a flaying knife, a single-pointed vajra, an axe, a spear, an arrow, an iron hook, a club, a khaṭvāṅga (Skt. khaṭvāṅga), a wheel, a vajra, a vajra-hammer, a sword, and cymbals.

In the left hands: a skull cup, a severed head, a tent, a leg, a lasso, a bow, intestines, a bell, a hand, a charnel-ground cloth, a man impaled on a wooden stake, a brazier, a skull garland, a threatening finger-gesture (Skt. tarjanī mudrā), a three-pronged trident, and a cloth billowing in the wind.

With two hands draw him holding a fresh elephant hide.

With the right feet he tramples upon a human, a buffalo, an ox, a donkey, a camel, a dog, a sheep, and a fox.

With the left feet he tramples upon a vulture, an owl, a crow, a parrot, a hawk, a large bird, a lizard, and a laughing bird.

Thus draw the great Vajrabhairava standing in this manner. Below him, draw also the great charnel ground. It should be seen to contain figures that inspire great terror — rākṣasas (Skt. rākṣasa), and the guardian of the charnel ground, and a man who has become a zombie, impaled on the tip of a spear. Draw men hanging from the branches of nyagrodha (Skt. nyagrodha) trees; also draw men being burned.

Draw also the man impaled on the tip of a spear. Draw various kinds of birds, crows, dogs, and jackals letting out cries of laughter. Draw also the practitioners — naked with dishevelled hair, gazing one-pointedly at the Blessed One, adorned with the five mudrās, holding a caṇḍālī staff and a skull and a khaṭvāṅga (Skt. khaṭvāṅga), and crowned with a garland of skulls — laughing and entering into that charnel ground.

This is the secret painted image. Place it well in a single location, offer incense of great flesh before it, and recite mantras counted on a rosary of great conch shell. The mantra practitioner, remaining in meditative equipoise at the three times with diligence, shall guard the painted image. No other person whatsoever shall be placed near it, nor shall it be displayed before any other person. For recitation, drinking, eating, and feasting, one must always eat the token of great flesh. If one desires the supreme accomplishment (Skt. siddhi), one shall offer Vairocana and blood incense before the painted image at the

three times.

This is the fifth section on the ritual of the painted image from the tantra called Mañjuśrī's Great Vajrabhairava Yoga.

Then the rite of the burnt-offering action was taught. Following the procedure as before: first the mantra practitioner goes to a solitary place, and at midnight performs all the actions of the burnt offering, abiding in the divine yoga described above and performing all actions accordingly. The actions are as follows.

If one wishes to slay, one takes human bones, Vairocana, the urine of a donkey, the urine of a dog, thorns, hair, and nails — mixes all of these with hot butter oil, blends them with the application of Mahī, enters into deep meditative equipoise, faces southward, and burns them one hundred and eight times in a fire of burning corpses, together with the name of the target. Without doubt, that person will die within three days.

Alternatively, remaining in one place and making a triangular fire hearth, one performs the burnt offering in a fierce fire using the substances described above. Through that application, the very same action is accomplished.

If one wishes to separate, one burns crow, owl, peacock, snake, hair, rice husks, mahī, and horse flesh, all together with the name of the person, reciting the ten-syllable mantra in a charnel-ground fire — and thereby separation will occur.

Alternatively, one lights an exceedingly fierce fire in charnel-ground wood while remaining at home, and burns the substances described above. Even someone who is like a vajra-holder (Skt. vajradhara) will be separated within seven days.

If one wishes to drive away, one burns crow flesh and the tip of a vixen's tail together with beer, fully combined, in the center of the maṇḍala of wind, having lit a great fire in charnel-ground wood. One transforms oneself into a naked figure with dishevelled hair, faces toward the south, and makes one thousand burnt offerings with the left hand reciting the mantra of Yama together with the name of the person. This results in nothing other than expulsion.

If one wishes to paralyze, one makes a square maṇḍala using the resin of the bala plant, turmeric, lodhra tree sap, and civet, looks toward the north, focuses with the application that follows after the action, and performs the

burnt offering together with the name of the person. That person will be paralyzed within seven days.

If one wishes to expel an entire village, one lights a great fire in nimba wood and mixes dog flesh, frog flesh, domestic fowl flesh, the tip of a vixen's tail, and cat's blood all together. Remaining in the application of Yama, one makes ten thousand burnt offerings in the center of the maṇḍala of wind using the ten-syllable mantra, together with the name of the village — and the village will be expelled.

All these actions are to be performed with extremely deep meditative equipoise. Otherwise, the mantra practitioner himself will be harmed by them. They are not to be shown to any other person whatsoever.

Then, if one wishes to paralyze a woman, one mixes thorns, poison, and birthwort together with one's own blood, and —

— together with the ten-syllable mantra, reciting "May the woman be paralyzed!" — and if one makes a thousand burnt offerings in a cremation-ground fire, she will be paralyzed, and nothing else.

Then, if one wishes to perform a pacifying action, one ignites a fire of bālā wood together with butter, honey, milk, and dūrvā grass. Visualizing the aim of pacification, one faces east toward the village, and by performing one thousand and eight burnt offerings across the three times, the village will be pacified.

Then, if one wishes to perform an enriching action, one ignites a fire of udumbara wood together with sesame, rice, barley, and butter. Visualizing the application of the deity who follows in the wake of the action, one faces upward and, resting in meditative equipoise, performs one thousand burnt offerings with the ten-syllable mantra across the three times — and enrichment will come about.

Then, if one wishes to magnetize someone, one makes an effigy out of white mustard seeds, and burns it one hundred and eight times in the center of an acacia fire with the mantra of Yamāntaka. What had not been accomplished will come to be accomplished. Within seven days, whoever one desires will undoubtedly be magnetized.

Then, if one wishes to drive someone mad, one burns the nest of a large vulture together with great flesh — and that person will go mad. If that same material is burned in a thatched-roof fire, the person will recover and be well.

Then, if one wishes to cause wealth to be lost, one performs one hundred and eight burnt offerings at night with the ten-syllable mantra, using datura fruit together with a cotton-wool fire — and the wealth will be utterly wasted. If āmalaka fruit is burned, the wealth will be restored to exactly what it was.

In front of the venerable one, if one performs one hundred and eight burnt offerings each night for six months using great flesh together with alcohol, one will become the lord of all lands.

If one performs a thousand burnt offerings with beef together with blood, including the name of a particular person, that person will undoubtedly remain a servant for as long as they live.

If the mantra practitioner himself performs one hundred and eight burnt offerings at night with dog flesh together with vajra-water, including the name of a particular person, that person together with their wealth will come under one's control.

If one stays in a single place and performs one hundred and eight burnt offerings with horse flesh together with Vairocana, using the mantra of Yamāntaka, at night with a king as the visualized object — within seven days, the king together with his entire retinue will come under control.

If one visualizes all of the human world and performs a thousand burnt offerings at night with the ten-syllable mantra using elephant flesh together with its bile, within seven days all will come under control.

If one performs one hundred and eight burnt offerings fearlessly with the ten-syllable mantra using fish, flesh, and alcohol together, all women will come under control.

Then, if one wishes to drive someone away, one performs a thousand burnt offerings with the ten-syllable mantra, using crow flesh unmixed with anything else, including the name of the person — and within seven days, even one like Vajrapāṇi will flee utterly; what need is there to speak of an ordinary person?

Then, if one ignites a fire of datura wood together with a crow's nest and the chaff of rice, and at midnight performs burnt offerings with the ten-syllable mantra including the name of the person — within seven days, that person will be expelled.

Then, if one wishes to bring someone under control, one mixes sesame, rice, and a woman's flower together with vajra-water, ignites an acacia fire, visualizes the red-colored form of the yogi, faces west, and the mantra

practitioner burns these while reciting the ten-syllable mantra together with the name of the person. Within seven days that person will be drawn under control, and for as long as they live the two will never part.

Then, if one wishes to summon someone, one makes one hundred and eight burnt offerings in an acacia fire using the five nectars together with butter, including the name of the person — and that person will come in that very instant.

All these actions are to be performed by a mantra practitioner who has previously completed the approach practice.

If these actions are performed by another, the mantra practitioner will be condemned by the worldly. One must not reveal the distinctions of the practice to anyone at all — distinctions are not to be given out. If the distinctions are disclosed, the mantra practitioner will not achieve the spiritual attainments (siddhi). I have also taught this in other tantras:

Just as distinctions should not arise,
so too one speaks of distinctions in what is to be done —
even Vajrasattva will not accomplish it
before a mantra practitioner in whose presence
these actions are seen to be performed.
Therefore do not perform these actions before others,
nor together with others in any other setting.
If a mantra practitioner wishes to perform these actions,
let them be performed by that one alone —
it is that mantra practitioner who performs all the actions.

This is the sixth chapter — the extensive deliberation on the ritual of burnt offering from the tantra called the Glorious Vajrabhairava Yoga of Mañjuśrī.

Then the proper ritual of the action of meditative concentration is fully taught. All that is needed is to be fully accomplished through the combination of meditative concentration and mantra. As the opening of the ritual, the yogi must first perform the approach practice while abiding in the union of the buffalo-faced one, and then all the actions are to be performed.

One should vividly visualize a maṇḍala of fire, blazing and utterly brilliant, arisen from the syllable RAM. Above it one visualizes the subject to be worked upon — naked, with disheveled hair, terrified — present before oneself. One then emanates from one's own body a multitude of wrathful figures, and one

should visualize those wrathful ones stabbing with swords, drinking blood, eating the flesh of that subject, and pulling out the entrails.

One should speak these words: "Strike! Strike! Destroy! Destroy! — upon those who harm the Three Jewels and those who slander the guru." By this contemplation alone, even a holder of the vajra will die within seven days — how much the more so other, lesser living beings.

Then another application of the meditation of meditative concentration: while abiding in the pride of the union of the buffalo-faced one, one should accomplish all actions. One should visualize the subject weeping in the center of the fire maṇḍala, with many rākṣasas before them — those rākṣasas being beings of various forms, wicked, extremely fierce, eating flesh and drinking blood. Furthermore, one should visualize birds of many kinds — vultures, crows, owls, foxes, and dogs — eating flesh and drinking blood. Through this application of meditative concentration, the subject will without doubt die. Even a person situated a hundred leagues away can be seized by the mind and the meditation begun. The mantra practitioner should stabilize the meditative concentration.

Then, if one wishes to sow discord, one should visualize the subject in the heart of the buffalo, and should visualize another subject in the heart of a horse. One then meditates on the horse and the buffalo fighting each other, and this continues until the horse and the buffalo are separated from each other. Thereafter one should meditate on those two subjects being bitterly hostile to one another — through this contemplation alone, within seven days they will certainly come to quarrel, not otherwise.

Then, if one wishes to drive someone away, one should visualize a female drum arisen from the syllable YAM. Behind it one should visualize a wind maṇḍala arisen from the form of YAM, in the shape of a half-moon. Above it one should visualize the subject — naked, with disheveled hair, terrified. While abiding in the union of the buffalo-faced one, one should visualize behind the subject a form of Yamārāja, right hand holding a club, with hair disheveled. One shows the female drum with its mouth facing south and sends it forth. One should visualize while reciting the mantra of Yamārāja together with the name of that subject. By the yogi merely meditating thus, within seven days even a vajra-holder will be driven away.

Another application of meditative concentration: one should visualize the subject with hair unbound and naked upon the back of a crow or vulture.

Behind the subject one should visualize Yamārāja, right hand holding a club and grasping the subject by the hair, commanded by the buffalo-faced one to go, facing south. One should visualize him departing in that direction. When this is contemplated with single-pointed application, by that single-pointed application the subject will be driven away within seven days.

Then, if one wishes to summon someone, one visualizes a wind maṇḍala arisen from the syllable YAM. Above that, a moon maṇḍala arisen from the syllable A. Above that, one visualizes the form of Yamārāja holding an iron hook and a lasso in his hands. Abiding in the yoga of the buffalo-faced one, one commands him thus: "Yamārāja, go! From the great country, quickly summon the great woman!" Having issued that command, one should visualize the wind-nature stirring and departing. By applying this meditative concentration, the yogi is able to summon women belonging to any of the three realms and take pleasure with them. As long as the meditation is firm and stable, this application alone can accomplish all of that — none other can do the same.

Then the application for taking up the antidote to snakebite is taught. One visualizes within one's own heart a white lotus with eight petals. Upon it, one visualizes the third vowel letter, and upon the eight petals, the syllable PHAṬ eight times. By means of this, one visualizes below it the form of a nāga. At its crown one visualizes the white syllable I, from which nectar drips. From the eyes of that nāga nectar streams forth and is visualized as dissolving into the body of the subject. By this application of the meditative concentration, even a poison filling the entirety of the three realms will be rendered powerless. One can eat even a thousand doses of poison.

Then comes the application of the liquefying meditative concentration. One visualizes the subject in front. At the subject's two feet, one visualizes a wind maṇḍala arisen from the syllable YAM. Above that, at the secret place, one visualizes a triangular fire maṇḍala, red in color, consecrated by the syllable RAM. Above that, at the heart, one visualizes a square earth maṇḍala, yellow in color, consecrated by the syllable LAM. Above that, at the forehead, one visualizes a moon maṇḍala. At its center, one visualizes the syllable BĀM resting with its head pointing downward, from which nectar drips. Having clearly visualized all this, one kindles the fire with the wind. One then visualizes that fire burning the Great God's (Śiva's) maṇḍala. By the heat of the Great God's maṇḍala, one visualizes the nectar maṇḍala above melting.

By this application alone,
that one's woman will melt,
like a tree of milk —
there is no doubt she will dissolve.

Then, if one wishes to bring a king or a king's minister under one's power, the mantra practitioner should thoroughly abide in the yoga of the buffalo-faced one, visualizing him as red in color, and should position himself above wherever the subject resides. Then one projects outward from one's own body a red form of Mañjuśrī, holding an iron hook and lasso in hand. One visualizes that Mañjuśrī binding the subject at the heart and throat, drawing the subject in, and merging him into the body of Mañjuśrī. One visualizes the subject becoming intoxicated. At the subject's heart one visualizes the mantra of ten syllables. Moreover, the practitioner of the red color practice should, through the form of gnosis, enter into the syllable, and cause that syllable and the subject to become one. By this application of meditative concentration, even a wheel-turning monarch will come under one's power within seven days, and for as long as he lives there is no doubt of this. The mantra practitioner, well settled in equipoise, should perform this with unwavering meditative concentration. This is not to be given to just any tantra.

Furthermore, the mantra is not to be revealed. The meditative concentration of glorious Vajrabhairava the Great, he of the buffalo face, is not to be given to just anyone, nor spoken of, nor is any classification of the mantra to be made. Nor is a painted image to be displayed before anyone; the thangka is to be kept secret. The practice of this tantra — its application, its recitation, and its teaching — is not to be spoken of even in the slightest to any other person. If it is spoken of, glorious Vajrabhairava, along with the yoginīs and the ḍākinīs, will devour that person. The samaya vow will be broken. Therefore the mantra practitioner is not to give this to anyone.

Now, a hero who possesses equanimity in samaya, who is free from conceptual thought, who is possessed of supreme sacred conduct, who is devoted and disciplined toward the lama, who holds firm to the teaching of the Tathāgata, who conceals the tantra, who is not given to anger, who is endowed with compassion, who is inclined toward recitation and meditative concentration, and who overcomes karmic maturation — one who possesses these exceptional qualities is a good student. Such a student is supremely devoted to the sacred maṇḍala of glorious Vajrabhairava the Great, his mind moistened by great compassion, free from conceptual thought, supremely

devoted to the lama, and one who has reflected deeply and examined thoroughly. To such a student the lama gives the tantra of glorious Vajrabhairava the Great.

If the mantra practitioner gives this to another who does not possess these qualities, there is no doubt that both he and his student will go to hell. In this present world great fear will arise, and in the world beyond they will go to hell. The samaya vow will also be broken.

This is the seventh chapter of inquiry, entitled the accomplishment of the work of meditative concentration, from the tantra of the yoga of glorious Vajrabhairava the Great, known as Mañjuśrī.

This accomplishment of the section of inquiry, extracted and compiled from the great hundred-thousand-verse wheel tantra of glorious Vajrabhairava the Great, through the reading of which siddhis are accomplished — the inquiry into the accomplishment of the siddhis of glorious Vajrabhairava the Great, he of the buffalo face — is hereby complete.

Extracted from the great sacred place of glorious Oḍḍiyāna, drawn from the tantra of glorious Mañjuśrī: the great king of tantras called glorious Vajrabhairava the Great — brought forth and composed by the venerable master of the great maṇḍala, the holy lama, glorious Lālitavajra — is hereby complete.

Translator's Notes

- The text opens with a colophon fragment attributing a revision to "Vajraghosa" — this is unusual as a colophon placed at the opening, suggesting a scribal or editorial insertion before the formal title. The Sanskrit title is preserved in the Tibetan phonetic transcription and translates as "The Glorious Vajra Great Bhairava, a Tantra."

The phrase rendered "noble buffalo-faced one" refers to Mañjuśrī Yamāntaka in his buffalo-faced Bhairava form; "noble" here translates the standard honorific prefix rather than the technical ārya designation in the doctrinal sense.

The "five mudrās of the charnel-ground seal" are here the five symbolic objects placed in the center of the maṇḍala, understood as mudrās in the sense of symbolic markers or signs rather than hand gestures.

- The term rendered "Vairocana" throughout this passage is used not as the buddha Vairocana but as a ritual substance — almost certainly a specific sacred substance or ointment named after or associated with Vairocana. The precise identification of this substance is uncertain in the tradition; it may refer to white mustard oil or a consecrated ointment. This is a consequential ambiguity for readers expecting the buddha's name.

The phrase "right-contracted posture" renders a specific tantric sitting position in which the right leg is drawn in; this is a standard yogic posture for wrathful deity practice.

The "thirty-two-syllable mantra" combined with the "ten-syllable mantra" reflects a layered mantra system specific to the Vajrabhairava cycle; the exact syllabic counts are doctrinal claims of the text, not scribal errors.

- The term rendered "chameleon" for སྐྱུ་འཕྲུལ་ is uncertain; this word has been identified in some contexts as a type of lizard, possibly a gecko or agama. The doctrinal stakes are low but a specialist in Tibetan natural history might refine this.

The phrase བྱེད་པའི་མཐོང་པོ་ལྟ་བུ་ལྟོས་པའི་སྒྲུབ་པ་, rendered "sādhana of the mahā face," is a technical ritual term. བྱེད་པའི་ refers to a buffalo or buffalo-faced deity, likely associated with Yama (whose mount is a buffalo); "mahā face" follows the Tibetan syllabification but could also be read as "buffalo-face sādhana." Either reading points to a Yama-related ritual application.

The term རྒྱལ་བོའི་རྩེད་ཆས་, rendered "banner cloth of the Great God (Śiva)," refers to a ritual cloth associated with Śiva's victory banner, a recognized tantric ritual item.

- The phrase "conjunction of the skull" renders 骨節結合, which appears to denote a specific ritual hand-gesture or grip involving an animal skull or skull-cup, likely a technical term for a tantric mudrā or implement-hold. Its precise technical referent in this context is somewhat opaque and may belong to a specific ritual lineage's terminology.

The phrase རྒྱུ་རྩེད་ཀློག་སྤྲེལ་བའི་མཁན་པོ་ཡི་ཐུག་པ་ is rendered "conjunction of the stacked-elements practice." This is a technical tantric term whose precise meaning here is uncertain; it may refer to a specific visualization or mudrā involving stacked elemental syllables or forms.

The passage ends mid-sentence, cutting off at the mention of the crow; this reflects the source text as given.

- The long central section of this passage is a highly technical tantric cryptogram describing the construction of a mantra syllable by syllable. The system refers to positions within the traditional Tibetan consonant table arranged by row and column, with vowel-letter numbers and seed-syllables for wind (likely *yaṃ* or *vaṃ*) and fire (likely *raṃ*). The passage as a whole is intentionally obscure, following the convention of deliberately veiled mantra-encoding found throughout the Vajrabhairava tantra cycle. A precise phonetic reconstruction of the resulting mantra cannot be made without recourse to a colophon or commentary tradition that identifies the specific grid being used. The translation renders the structural logic faithfully while making no attempt to identify the hidden syllables, as that would go beyond what the text itself makes explicit.

The term rendered "conjunction of Mahī" translates *ma hei sbyor ba*, which appears to be a technical tantric term, possibly a transliteration of a Sanskrit name or epithet associated with a deity or rite; its precise identity is uncertain.

- The passage is a cryptographic mantra-construction text in which each mantra syllable is described by identifying a consonant by its position in the Tibetan syllabary and then specifying which vowel-mark it bears, along with additional seed-syllables such as the fire-seed RAM and wind-seed YAM. The phrase "the lord of the realm at the sixteenth end" renders *mnga' bdag bcu drug mtha'*, which refers to the visarga or anusvāra-like terminal marker at the sixteenth position of the vowel-sign system in traditional Tibetan tantric phonological classification. The precise reconstruction of each mantra syllable from this code is a matter for specialist commentary and has not been attempted here. The term "seed of the eighth semivowel" renders *ya tshogs brgyad pa'i sa bon*, referring to the eighth letter among the semivowels in the traditional Tibetan phonological classification, which in tantric usage designates a specific seed-syllable; its exact identity depends on the particular syllabary system being used by this text.

- The term rendered as "buffalo" throughout glosses the Tibetan transliteration of Sanskrit

mahiṣa, the male water buffalo, which is the animal closely associated with Yamāntaka in this iconographic context.

The phrase rendered as "laughing one" for the eighth left-foot creature reflects an uncertain reading; the Tibetan "bzhad" may indicate a laughing or smiling being, though the precise identity is not specified in the text itself.

- The "five nectars" refers to the five ritual substances of inner tantric offering, typically identified as urine, feces, blood, semen, and marrow or flesh, though listings vary by tradition. The doctrinal context here is clearly tantric antinomian practice.

The "hero's cloth" and related materials are well-attested tantric ritual supports; "hero" here renders Skt. *vīra*, a class of tantric being.

The bird identified here as "laughing bird" renders the Tibetan term that likely refers to the laughing thrush or similar species; the exact identification is uncertain but does not affect doctrinal meaning.

"Nyagrodha" is the Indian fig or banyan tree, a tree associated in Buddhist literature with charnel grounds and ascetic practices.

- The term rendered "great flesh" (*sha chen*) is a standard tantric technical term for one of the transgressive substances used in left-hand ritual practice, here functioning both as incense offering and as a ritual token consumed during practice sessions.

The phrase translated "Vairocana" in the context of burnt offerings likely refers to a ritual substance associated with the deity Vairocana, possibly sesame or white mustard, rather than the deity himself. This is a recognized usage in Vajrabhairava ritual literature, though the exact substance is not specified in this passage.

"Caṇḍālī staff" renders "cang te'u," a staff associated with outcast women, here a Vajrayāna ritual implement. The Tibetan caṇḍālī (*cang te'u*) is retained in the translation description as a general descriptor.

- The term rendered "vajra-water" is *rdorje'i chu*, a ritual substance associated with tantric contexts, likely consecrated or empowered water. Its precise composition is not specified in the text.

The phrase "a woman's flower" is a Tibetan euphemism for menstrual blood, a standard ingredient in certain tantric rites of this category.

"Great flesh" is a standard tantric term for beef (one of the five meats used in Vajrayāna ritual contexts), though in some contexts it refers to human flesh; here, the explicit later mention of beef separately makes the referent in those earlier instances uncertain. This is noted for scholarly awareness.

The "five nectars" are a standard set of tantric ritual substances.

- The term rendered "female drum" translates a visualization of a drum-like object arising from the syllable YAM; this is a standard tantric visualization element where the seed-syllable transforms into a ritual implement or symbolic form. The precise shape described, compared to a half-moon, suggests a crescent-shaped wind-maṇḍala supports the drum figure above it.

The phrase rendered "union of the buffalo-faced one" refers throughout to the meditative identification with Vajrabhairava in his buffalo-headed form, the central deity of this tantra, into whose pride the practitioner absorbs themselves before performing any of the contemplative actions described.

- The phrase "third vowel letter" refers to the Indic vowel syllable *I* (the short *i* in the Sanskrit vowel series: A, Ā, I...), which is the third member of the standard Sanskrit vowel enumeration

as used in Tibetan tantric syllabary practice.

The phrase "tree of milk" likely refers to a milk-tree or tree from which milk flows — a conventional image for effortless dissolution or liquefaction; the simile is straightforward but its precise resonance may be contextually tantric.

The "mantra of ten syllables" is a standard tantric reference that would be specified in the root tantra being drawn upon; it is not spelled out here and is left as given.

- The epithet "महिषामर्दिनी" literally means "having the face of a mahiṣa (water buffalo)," which is Vajrabhairava's iconic form. It is rendered here as "he of the buffalo face" for clarity in speech.

The colophon names the master as "Lālitavajra," a known tantric ācārya associated with the transmission of Vajrabhairava texts from Oḍḍiyāna (the sacred region often identified with the Swat Valley). The reading of his name in Tibetan transliteration is unambiguous.

The phrase "克服業熟" ("overcomes karmic maturation") is somewhat elliptical; it may refer to one who has mastered or transcended ordinary karmic ripening through practice, and this rendering reflects the most natural doctrinal reading.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.